

Mexican brown rice with jalapeños and tomatillos

Fragrant jasmine rice also comes in a less-processed brown form, which has a great chewy texture. Here it becomes a beautiful green thanks to tart tomatillos and mildly hot jalapeño peppers.

4 tomatillos, husked and rinsed

¼ cup pine nuts [30g]

2 fresh jalapeño peppers

3 garlic cloves, unpeeled

¼ cup coarsely chopped cilantro [60ml]

2 teaspoons unrefined cane sugar

1 teaspoon salt

2½ cups plus 3 tablespoons vegetable stock
[625ml plus 3 tablespoons]

½ white onion, chopped

1 tablespoon olive oil

1 cup brown jasmine or other long-grain
brown rice [200g]

1. **Preheat** the broiler with a rack set 4 to 5 inches [10 to 13 cm] from the heat. Lay out the tomatillos on a baking pan and broil, turning until they are slightly blackened and softened, about 7 to 10 minutes. Coarsely chop the tomatillos and set them aside in a bowl along with their juices.
2. While the tomatillos are broiling, **toast** the pine nuts in a dry skillet over medium heat until they brown lightly. Toss and turn constantly so they don't burn. Set aside on a plate.
3. For your next step, make sure your kitchen is well ventilated. In the same skillet, **dry-roast** the jalapeño peppers and garlic cloves, turning every so often, until lightly blackened all over. Remove the stems from the hot peppers and coarsely chop.
4. In a blender or food processor, **combine** the tomatillos, roasted peppers and garlic, cilantro, sugar, salt, and 3 tablespoons stock. Puree until smooth.

5. In a medium saucepan, **sauté** the onion in the olive oil until very soft, 3 to 4 minutes. Add the rice and stir continuously for about 1 minute. Raise the heat to high and add the tomatillo sauce (it should sizzle); stir for about 30 seconds.
6. **Add** the remaining stock and bring to a boil. Cover, reduce to a simmer, and cook for 20 to 25 minutes, or until the rice is tender. Remove from the heat and let stand, covered, for 10 minutes before serving, garnished with the pine nuts.

SERVES 4

note If the rice is not done but the liquid has evaporated, add $\frac{1}{4}$ cup [60ml] boiling water (from a kettle) and continue to cook. Repeat if necessary.

